

INDIE SAAS ECONOMY REPORT

What Actually Pulls Users and Revenue in Indie SaaS

Categories, monetization, audience, and domain quality across 1,000 live startups
— and the throughline connecting all four.

As of 30 Jul 2026



The trust layer behind indie SaaS revenue

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Verified, not screenshotted

Founders connect Stripe, RevenueCat, Paddle, Polar and other processors through read-only API keys, so the revenue shown is pulled live from the source — not a screenshot that can be edited.

+

Born from build-in-public culture

It grew out of the indie hacker habit of sharing monthly revenue milestones, where trust in the numbers behind the milestone had become the biggest open question.

\$

A marketplace, not just a leaderboard

A meaningful share of listed profiles carry an asking price and revenue multiple, turning verified revenue histories into acquisition listings buyers can screen directly.

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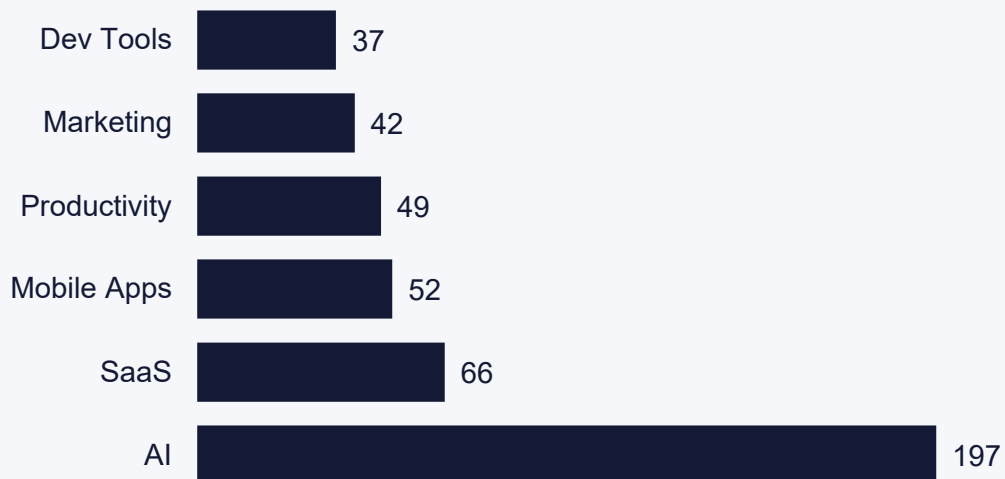
What this analysis does with it

We look at where these verified startups actually win — by category, monetization approach, market, and domain strength — to find the patterns that hold up.

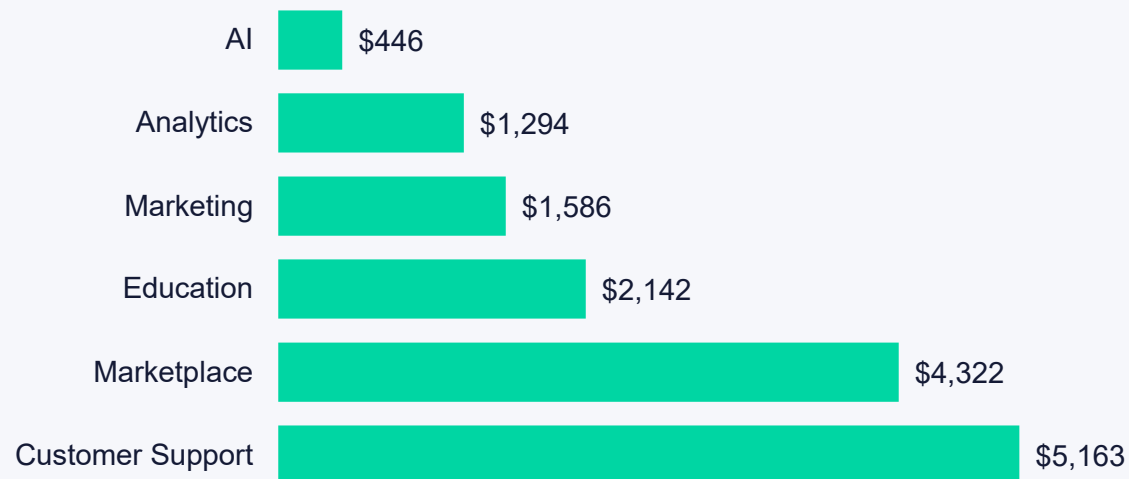
CATEGORIES

The most crowded category is not the most rewarded one

WHERE FOUNDERS SHOW UP · startups by category



WHERE THE MONEY ACTUALLY IS · median MRR (\$)

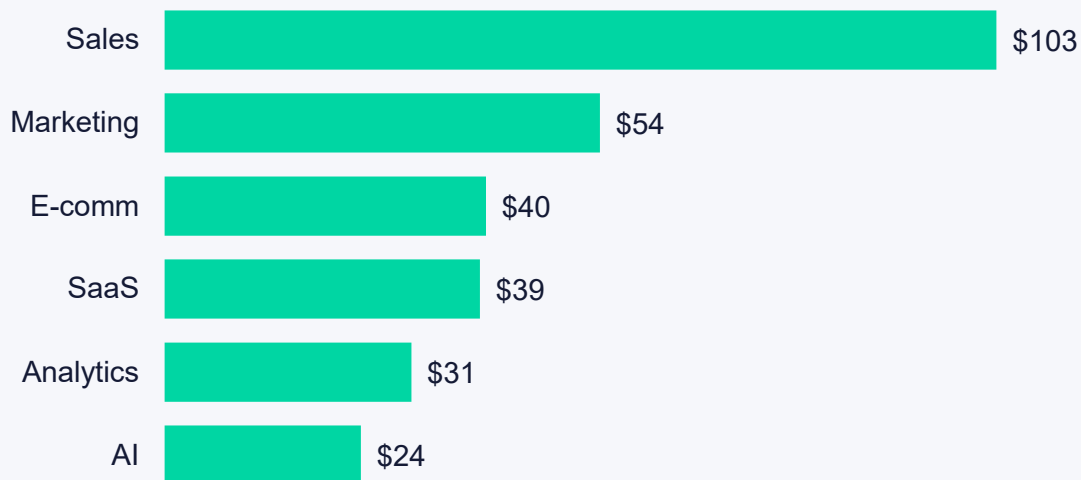


AI is the default first move, not the smart one. AI startups outnumber Customer Support tools 39-to-1, yet Customer Support carries the highest median MRR in the dataset (\$5,163) — more than 11× AI's median (\$446). Founders are chasing the crowd, not the ARPU. Marketplace and Education tell the same story: small supply, strong pricing power.

MONETIZATION

Not all customers are worth the same price

PRICE PER CUSTOMER BY CATEGORY, \$



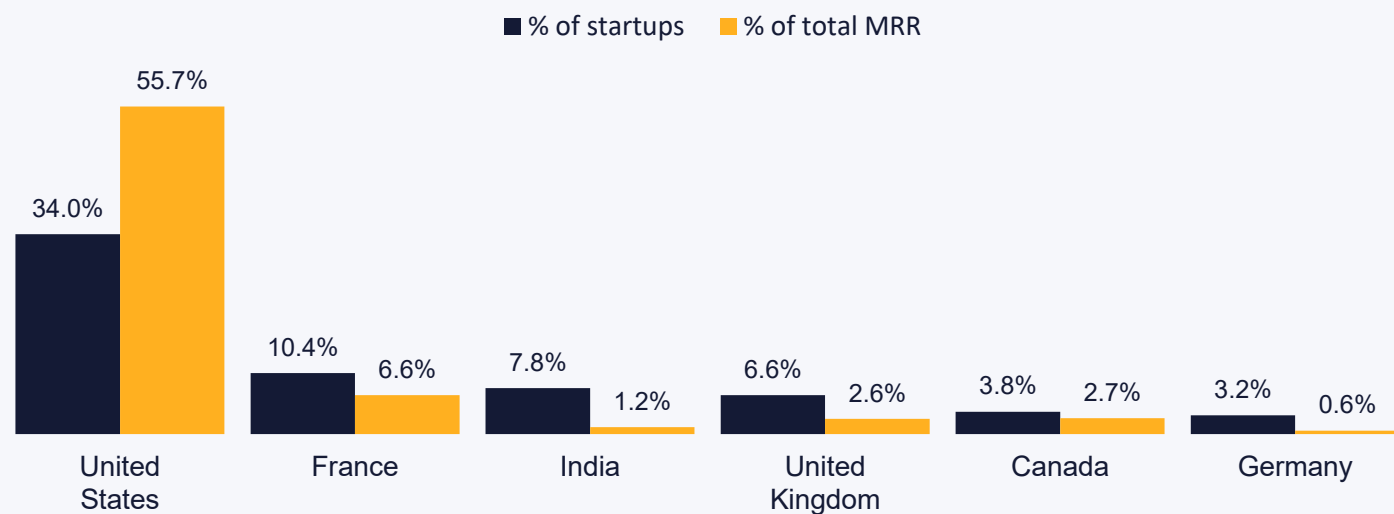
PRICE PER CUSTOMER BY STRATEGY, \$



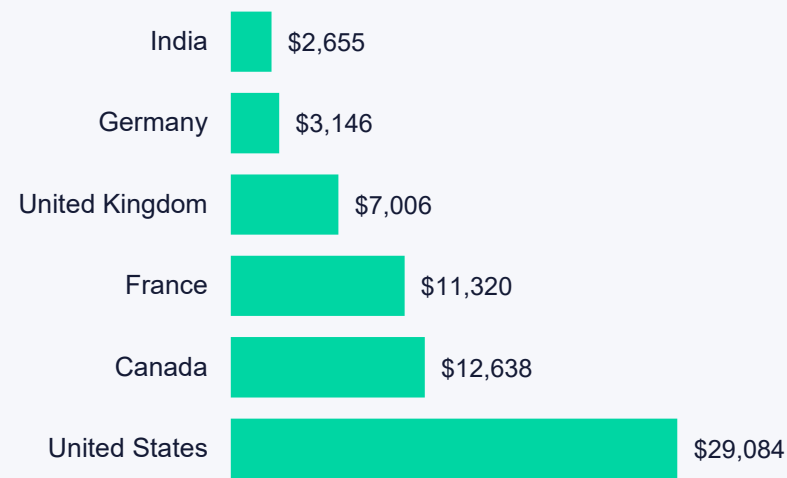
Pricing power varies more than total revenue does. Sales tools charge over 4× what a typical SaaS product yields per customer (\$103 vs. \$39), while AI — the most crowded category on the platform — captures just \$24 per subscriber, roughly a quarter of Sales' rate. The same pattern holds for strategy: products that charge from day one still out-earn freemium 3× per customer (\$29 vs. \$10), not just in aggregate MRR. Willingness to charge shows up per-customer, not only at scale.

Where startups launch isn't where revenue lands

STARTUPS VS. REVENUE SHARE BY MARKET, %



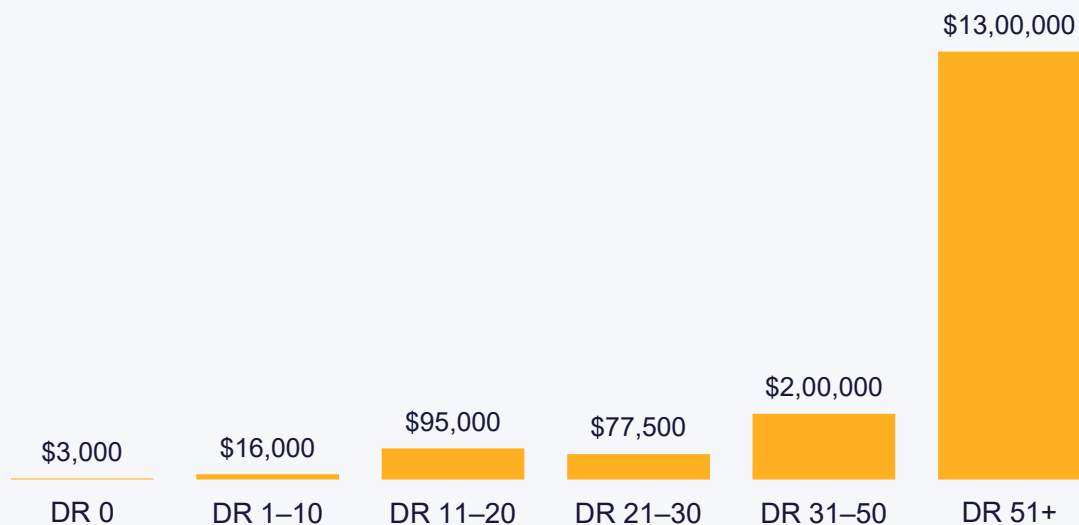
REVENUE PER STARTUP, \$



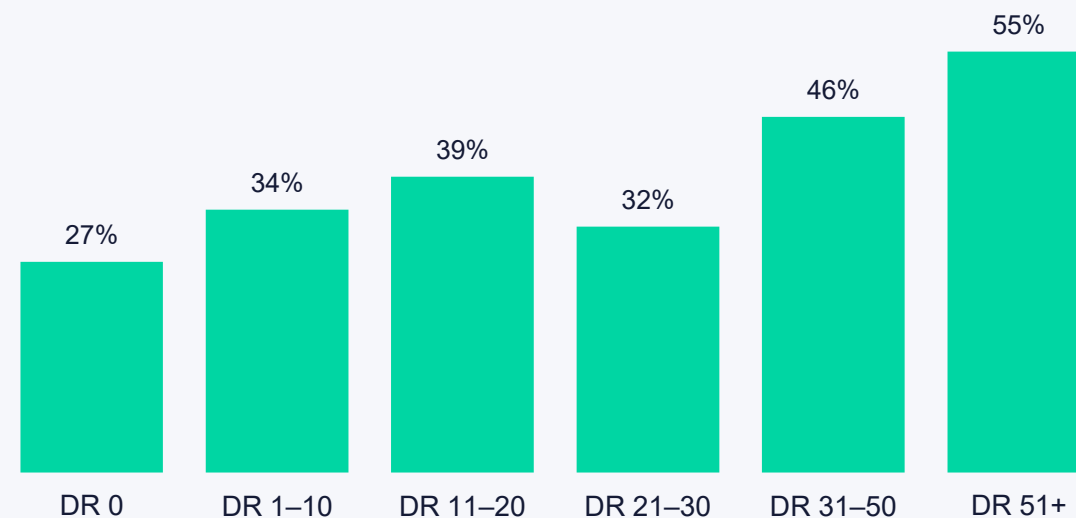
Revenue concentrates far more tightly than startup count does. The US holds 34% of startups with a listed country but captures 56% of total MRR — a 1.6× over-index — and the highest revenue per startup of any major market (\$29,084). India sits at the opposite extreme: 8% of startups, just 1% of revenue, and the lowest revenue per startup in the top six (\$2,655, 11× below the US). Same platform, same playbook available to everyone — very different payoffs by market.

A strong domain pays off twice — in revenue and at exit

ASKING PRICE BY DOMAIN TIER, \$



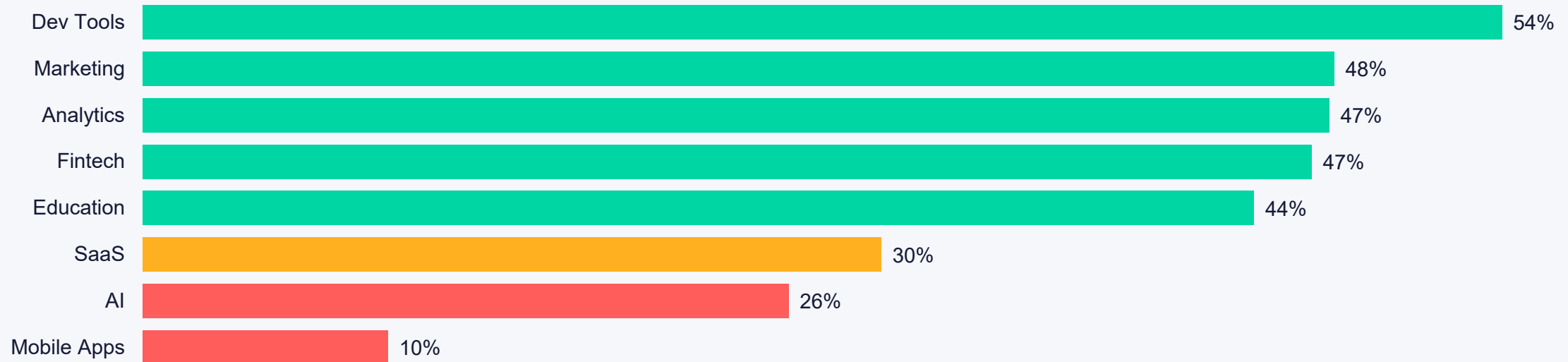
% STILL GROWING BY DOMAIN TIER



Domain authority isn't a growth boost that fades — it compounds twice. Startups in the top domain-rating tier command a median asking price of \$1.3M, 433× the \$3,000 median at DR 0. Contrary to the idea that established domains have plateaued, that same top tier also has the highest share of startups still adding revenue month-over-month (55%, vs. 27% at DR 0) — strong domains keep compounding.

AI has more startups shrinking than growing

SHARE OF STARTUPS GROWING MONTH OVER MONTH, %



Supply and momentum are pointing in opposite directions. Despite fielding far more startups than any other category, AI has more companies shrinking (35%) than growing (26%) in a given month — the weakest momentum of any major category besides Mobile Apps. Dev Tools sits at the opposite end: 54% of listed Dev Tools startups grew last month, roughly double AI's rate. Where founders are showing up isn't where the growth is actually happening.

One in four of these startups is already for sale

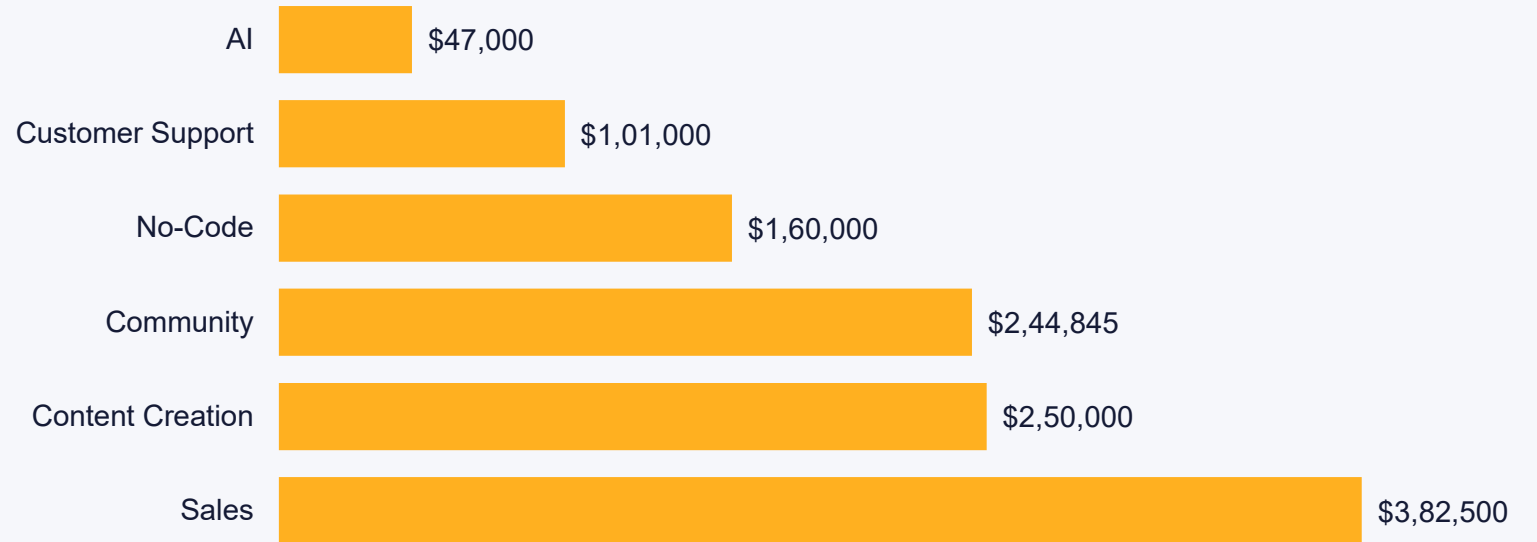
26.2%

of listed startups are up for sale

\$35,000

median asking price among listings

MEDIAN ASKING PRICE BY CATEGORY (\$) • where listed



%

AI is cheap to buy relative to its supply. Despite being the largest category by far, AI's median asking price (\$47K) sits well below leaner categories like Sales and Content Creation — more sellers, more substitutable products, less pricing power at exit, echoing the same volume-without-value pattern we saw earlier with categories overall.

Four data points, one story

01

Supply chases hype

AI attracts 3× more founders than the next category, but crowding compresses its median revenue to the bottom third of the field.

02

Value hides in quiet categories

Customer Support, Marketplace, and Education post the highest median MRR precisely because fewer founders compete there.

03

Business buyers and upfront pricing win

B2B beats B2C 5.7× on median MRR; charging from day one beats endless freemium 6×. Confidence in the product shows up as confidence in the price.

04

Domain equity is the multiplier on all of it

At every category, price point, and audience, a stronger domain rating compounds revenue exponentially — and it pays off again at exit, through higher acquisition offers.

A decorative graphic in the top-left corner of the slide, consisting of several small, colored dots (teal, orange, and grey) scattered across the dark blue background.

WHERE TO BUILD, PRICE, AND BUY NEXT

**Build outside
the crowd.
Price like you
mean it.**

Source: TrustMRR public profiles · Data as of 30 Jul 2026